

Procurement and Atmanirbharta' was organised by ELCINA (Electronic Industry Association of India) in collaboration with Ernst & Young (EY). The discussion focused on various aspects, including defence production, domestic manufacturing, offset policy, opportunities for MSMEs and startups, among others.

Moderated by Col. KV Kuber (retd), director, Aerospace & Defence, EY India, the imminent panel of experts included:

- Sanjay Jaju, JS (DIP), Ministry of Defence, government of India
- Lt Gen. Sanjay Verma, AVSM (Ati Vishisht Seva Medal), VSM (Vishisht Seva Medal), DG of Weapons and Equipment (DGWE), Ministry of Defence
- Lt Gen. AKS Chandele (retd), PVSM (Param Vishisht Seva Medal), AVSM, senior advisor, ELCINA
- Col H.S. Shankar, VSM (retd), CMD, Alpha Design Technologies
- JD Patil, director and senior executive vice president, L&T defence business
- Emmanuel de Roquefeuil, vice

president and country director, Thales India

- Ankit Tyagi, manager, aerospace and defence, EY India

Domestic manufacturing

In its latest efforts to boost indigenous defence production, the government is planning to introduce a list of weapons/platforms to ban imports with year-wise timelines. **Priority will be given to the indigenisation of spares that are currently imported, and a separate provision will be introduced in the budget to buy military hardware from domestic manufacturers.**

Sharing his perspective on the measures taken by the government, Lt Gen. AKS Chandele (retd) says, "The government will prepare a negative list of items and equipment, which will ban the import of particular equipment. So far, we have been relying on the defence procurement procedure, which has been incentive-based starting from IBM and on the other side by global. So, the idea is to incentivise domestic design and manufacture. The negative list will ensure that items

which can be produced in the country, and which the Indian industry has the capability of producing, shall not be open for import."

Highlighting the scenario on the manufacturing aspect, Sanjay Jaju says, "India has a huge requirement, and the bulk of this requirement has been met through imported routes in the past. Nevertheless, we have made significant progress over the years, and a large number of defence platforms are being manufactured in our country."

He adds, "We also have a robust private sector, which is taking shape from 2001 onward, and close to 450 licenses have been given to the private sector. Many of these companies have been producing state-of-the-art and world-class equipment, which has been used by our services. We have also started to make decent progress in terms of exporting some of our products. And we have set a target of 5 billion dollars of export from India by 2024-25."

India has been making steady progress in exports and has seen a growth

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